cooked vegetables

Cut into dice, shredded, or left whole if small like sweet corn and peas, cooked vegetables can be added to a soup just before serving and heated through. Alternatively, they can be popped in the blender along with the other ingredients and puréed.



leftover cabbage

homemade gravy

Capitalize on gravy's richness and depth of flavor by stirring it into meaty soups just before serving. If the sauce has acquired a skin since you first prepared it, carefully remove this beforehand with a slotted spoon.

boiled pasta

Small pasta shapes that have been cooked but not covered in sauce can turn a simple soup into a square meal. Add leftover pasta at the last minute and then heat it through gently.



chunks of cheese

scraps of cheese

Small chunks of Cheddar, Parmesan, and Gruyère never need go to waste when you make your own soups. Grate the cheese finely and use it to top croûtes. Broiled until golden brown and bubbling, these make a hearty topping for soups.

red or white wine

A small glass of white wine splashed into a fish soup will help bring out the flavor of the seafood, while a little red wine added to a rich meaty soup will lend body and depth.

cold potatoes

Cooked potatoes are a boon when making soups, since they give extra substance. Process them in the blender with the other ingredients or dice and add them to the pan just before serving and heat gently through.



leftover potatoes